

Tony Mason, PhD

tony@wamason.com • wamason.com LLC • wamason.com • [Google Scholar](https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=...) • [GitHub](https://github.com/tonymason) • [LinkedIn](https://www.linkedin.com/in/tonymason)

Summary

Systems researcher and technical expert. Nearly four decades of OS and kernel-level systems work, from the V Operating System at Stanford (1987-89) through Transarc (AFS, DCE/DFS, and the Episode file system, which remains in production today as the POSIX file system of IBM's z/OS platform 35+ years later), and 22 years at OSR Open Systems Resources designing Windows file system filter drivers (1994-2016). Twelve issued US patents in storage, file systems, and concurrency. Co-author of *lex & yacc* (O'Reilly) and *Windows NT Device Driver Development* (New Riders). PhD UBC under cross-institutional supervisors Margo Seltzer (UBC) and Ada Gavrilovska (Georgia Tech).

Twenty-three years of expert witness work across patent infringement, trade-secret, software-defect, and technology-misappropriation matters in US federal courts, BC Supreme Court, USPTO proceedings, and European jurisdictions.

Notable Litigation Credentials

- **Daubert challenge survived:** Federal court found qualifications and methodology admissible in *Cent Holdings v Wolfram Research* (U.S. District Court, N.D. Alabama) after opposing counsel sought to exclude testimony.
- **Cited by name at trial and on appeal:** Cited by name in both the trial court decision and the U.S. Court of Appeals for the Third Circuit's decision in *Elmagin Capital LLC v Chao Chen*. Only one of fifteen documented engagements to go to trial; jury verdict for client, upheld on appeal.
- **Markman hearing testimony:** Claim construction testimony in *Legato Systems v Network Specialists* (U.S. District Court, N.D. California).

Education

Doctor of Philosophy , Computer Science, <i>University of British Columbia</i>	2025
Master of Science , Computer Science, <i>Georgia Institute of Technology</i>	2017
Bachelor of Science , Mathematics, <i>University of Chicago</i>	1987

Expert Witness Engagements

Anonymized list below; named cases, parties, courts, and case numbers available on request.

- Software defect litigation, BC Supreme Court. Services: Preliminary review; anticipated trial testimony. (*active*)
- Employment contract / patent ownership dispute, King Cty. Super. Ct. (Wash.). Services: Opinion letter; testimony.
- Trade secret misappropriation, W.D. Mo.. Services: Expert report; deposition.
- Patent infringement (ticketing technology), W.D. Tex.. Services: Consulting expert.
- Breach of contract (software / real estate technology), BC Supreme Court. Services: Consulting expert.
- Trade secret misappropriation, N.D. Ala.. Services: Declaration; Daubert challenge survived; In-court Science Day tutorial.
- Trade secret misappropriation, E.D. Pa. (3d Cir.). Services: Expert report; deposition; trial testimony; cited in trial and appellate decisions.
- Patent infringement (streaming data technology), W.D. Wash.. Services: Rule 11 background report; complaint and IPR declarations.
- Technology misappropriation / commercial disparagement, Vilnius District Court, Lithuania. Services: Rebuttal report.
- Trade secret misappropriation, S.D.N.Y.. Services: Evidentiary review for expert report.
- Trademark infringement and antitrust (general internet technology), D. Nev.. Services: Declarations; deposition.
- Patent infringement (storage technology), D. Del.. Services: Background research for IPR filing.
- Patent infringement (medical device data systems), D. Del.. Services: Expert report; deposition; trial preparation.
- Patent infringement (data storage and backup), N.D. Cal.. Services: Expert report; deposition; Markman hearing testimony.

Patents

Twelve issued US patents in storage, file systems, and concurrency. Glossed descriptions available on request.

- [US 11,720,529](#): Methods and Systems for Data Storage
- [US 9,830,329](#): Methods and Systems for Data Storage
- [US 9,600,486](#): File System Directory Attribute Correction
- [US 9,535,759](#): Work Queue Thread Balancing
- [US 8,990,228](#): Arbitrary Data Transformation
- [US 8,903,874](#): File System Directory Attribute Correction
- [US 8,539,228](#): Managing Access to a Resource
- [US 8,521,752](#): Arbitrary Data Transformations
- [US 8,024,433](#): Managing Application Resources
- [US 7,949,693](#): Log-Structured Host Data Storage
- [US 7,809,897](#): Managing Lock Rankings
- [US 7,512,748](#): Managing Lock Rankings

Books

lex & yacc, O'Reilly & Associates (1990, 1992)

Windows NT Device Driver Development, New Riders (1998)

Windows NT File System Internals (OSR Classic Reprints), OSR Press (2006)

The NT Insider: 40+ articles (1996-2017), OSR Press (1996-2017)

Areas of Expertise

File systems and storage internals; OS internals; distributed systems; LLM systems and AI agent infrastructure; patent claim construction in systems; trade-secret technical analysis; software assessment.

Current AI/Systems Research (2026)

Active research in LLM reliability, observability, AI-agent infrastructure, context management, and AI governance, including multiple preprints in the past 12 months.